

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS GATHERING IN AGILE PROJECTS SUMMARY

Chanthou VOEUN

Table Content

Key different requirement gathering between Waterfall and Agile

01

Pros and cons of Waterfall and Agile requirement gathering

02

Agile business requirements are user stories and epics

03

Techniques for gathering Agile requirements

04

KEY DIFFERENT REQUIREMENT GATHERING BETWEEN WATERFALL AND AGILE

	Waterfall	Agile
Timing	Waterfall gathers all requirements upfront	Agile gathers them just-in-time
Changes	Requirement can only be changed with a change request	Requirement can be reprioritized or add/changed between sprint
Documentation	Requirement captured using requirements documentation (BRD)	Requirement captured in a backlog as epic and user stories
Scope	Scope is fixed and managed tightly, leading to "scope creep"	scope is variable , and new requirements are simply added to the backlog based on priority, eliminating scope creep
Delivery	Deliver at the end of the project	Deliver at the end of each sprint

PROS AND CONS OF WATERFALL AND AGILE REQUIREMENT GATHERING

WATERFALL

Pros	Cons
Requirements gathered upfront, bringing clarity for the entire project	Requirements may get obsolete over time, particularly for large project, and also change over time
Gathering requirements upfront helps with estimate for the entire project	Estimates may be off at project end due to various reasons
Easier to trace complete requirement traceability Matrix	Stakeholders may add more requirements that are needed

AGILE

Pros	Cons
Requirements are gathered just in time	Elicitation needs to happen frequently
Requirements gathering facilitates communication through user stories	Requirements gathering is not as effective if customers don't participate
Requirements are always up-to-date and prioritized	Frequent grooming is required and can take additional time

AGILE BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS ARE USER STORIES AND EPICS

The two main forms for Agile business requirements are user stories and epics

1. User Stories

User story is a requirement that adds value to the user such as scenario (clear, and adds value) and Captured on a Story Card. User stories should also adhere to the INVEST criteria: Independent, Negotiable, Valuable, Estimable, Small, and Testable

2. Epics

Epics is a group of related User Stories that cannot be finished within a single sprint.

TECHNIQUES FOR GATHERING AGILE REQUIREMENTS

01

Brainstorming: getting input from many participants in a rapid fire round allowing them to release all idea, and idea are evaluated based on merit.

02

Wireframes: the wireframe is usually black and white, accompanied the behavior of the elements, their relationships and their importance

03

User Interviews: talking to people who will use the software to avoid vague questions.

04

Observations: entails watching someone who is using the product like advantages and disadvantages.

05

User story writing workshops: in story-writing workshops, the customer team gets together to user stories.

06

Questionnaires: questionnaires should be avoided as a means of gathering requirements, but can be used to refine requirements later one.

BUSINESS ANALYST'S ROLE IN AGILE PROJECTS

The Business Analyst's role in Agile projects includes writing user stories, developing wireframes, maintaining and updating the product backlog, and supporting the development team. The BA's role in Agile differs significantly from traditional waterfall.